



UNEASY: Chinese President Hu Jintao with Manmohan

Chinese counterparts.

The Chinese retorted by saying that Koyu did not have an invitation. In Delhi, China's envoy Sun Yuxi told senior officials in the MEA that China considered Arunachal Pradesh a disputed territory. In Beijing, India's envoy Nirupama Rao found herself pitted against the great wall, with the Chinese adamant on not giving the visa to Koyu.

China's denial of a visa to a government official from Arunachal Pradesh once again reinforces its claim over the entire state and not just the disputed tract of Tawang. Earlier too, Beijing has denied visas to officials and legislators from the state.

By cancelling the trip and three other visits of IAS officers to China, Delhi has sent a strong signal to Beijing. But instead of a knee-jerk reaction and following a tit-for-tat diplomacy, rethinking India's options on Tibet and Taiwan should be a priority—prick the dragon where it hurts.

by Saurabh Shukla

SIGNPOSTS

DIED: Film producer **G. Srinivasan**, 49, while trekking in Manali. He was the brother of director Mani Ratnam and has produced films like *Yuva* and *Guru*.

SELECTED: Sarod maestro **Ustaad Ashish Khan**, as a fellow of the Royal Asiatic Society of Great Britain

and Ireland, UK's highest body of Asian arts. The society was founded in 1924 and is patronised by Prince Charles.

SENTENCED: Former Sikkim chief minister **Nar Bahadur Bhandari**, to one month jail in a disproportionate assets case, by a CBI court. He is currently the president of the Sikkim Pradesh Congress Committee.

DIED: Erstwhile ruler of the princely state of Wankaner in Gujarat, **Maharana Pratapsinh Jhala**, 100. He was a founder member of the Cricket Club of India.

Beijing Turns Truant Again

DELHI Despite the stated bonhomie in Sino-Indian relations, the spat between the neighbours has spilled out again over the refusal of a Chinese visa to Ganesh Koyu, a secretary in the Arunachal Pradesh Government. Koyu was part of a 107-member delegation of IAS officers of the 1971 batch scheduled to visit China for a mid-career programme organised by the Department of Personnel and Training.

Sources say that the Chinese embassy in Delhi knocked out Koyu's name

from the visa request list stating that he was a "Chinese national" since he was from Arunachal Pradesh, which China claims to be an integral part of its territory.

Following a high-level meeting between Prime Minister Manmohan Singh, External Affairs Minister Pranab Mukherjee, National Security Adviser M.K. Narayanan and Foreign Secretary Shiv Shankar Menon, it was decided that the Foreign Office should raise the issue at the highest level with their

VIS-A-VIS

VAYALAR RAVI Minister for Overseas Indian Affairs **versus** **CHENNAS R. NAMBOODIRI** Guruvayur temple high priest

“My son Ravikrishna is a Hindu. How can they prevent him from worshipping in the temple? The priest cannot behave this way.”



“Ravikrishna's mother is a Christian. As per temple rules, a person's religion is determined by his or her mother's religion.”

EPILOGUE: Not gods, but we humans make all the rules and later bicker over them.